SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT - FOR DEMONSTRATION ONLY

Acme Health, Utilization Management, 100 Example Parkway, Springfield (fictional)

NOTICE OF ADVERSE DETERMINATION - PRIOR AUTHORIZATION

Date: September 18, 2026
Member: Dana Whitfield
Member ID: AH-48213907
Requesting provider: Morgan Ellery, MD (fictional)
Service requested: MRI lumbar spine
Code: CPT 72148
Diagnosis codes: M54.16

Dear Dana Whitfield,

Acme Health reviewed the prior authorization request for MRI lumbar spine under Medical Policy AH-RAD-012. The request is denied because the service is not medically necessary for the member's condition based on the records submitted.

Determination type: Medical necessity

Reason for denial: Documentation does not show failure of at least 6 weeks of conservative therapy.

This decision is based on section 2.3 of policy AH-RAD-012. A clinician reviewed the records submitted with the request.

Your right to appeal: you or your provider may submit a written appeal within 60 days of this notice. The appeal must be received by November 17, 2026. Your provider may also request a peer-to-peer discussion with our medical director.

Independent external review: if the denial is upheld on appeal, or if we do not decide the appeal in time, you may ask for an independent external review by a clinical reviewer who is not part of Acme Health.

Sincerely,
Medical Director, Acme Health (fictional)